

Use-case scorecard

Score up to five candidate use cases against the same criteria, so they can be compared fairly. Each criterion has a weight that says how much it matters to the organisation.

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

Worked example. The three use cases from the seed template. The first nine scores are the seed's own. The seed did not score data readiness or delivery risk, so those scores, and the decisions, are illustrative.

PORTFOLIO
Seed use-case portfolio

DATE
Not recorded in the seed

SCORED BY
Not recorded in the seed

Scoring guide

Use these descriptions so that a score means the same thing to everyone. A 2 or a 4 sits between the descriptions on either side. Higher is always better. The weights are the defaults; criteria marked Added are new to this framework.

#	Criterion	Axis	Weight	Scores 1	Scores 3	Scores 5
1	Supports corporate strategy	Value	5	Not linked to any strategic objective	Supports a strategic objective indirectly	Directly delivers a named strategic objective
2	Builds on a strength	Value	2	Uses none of our recognised strengths	Uses one strength in part	Builds directly on a key strength
3	Reduces a weakness	Value	2	Leaves our weaknesses as they are	Reduces one weakness in part	Removes a significant weakness
4	Defends against a threat	Value	4	Does not address any threat	Reduces our exposure to one threat	Removes a major threat
5	Increases profit	Value	2	No measurable effect on profit	A measurable gain in one area of the business	A large gain across the business
6	Increases revenue	Value	3	No measurable effect on revenue	A measurable gain in one line of business	A large gain, or a new source of revenue
7	Increases the number of customers	Value	4	No effect on customer numbers	Wins or keeps customers in one segment	Wins or keeps customers across segments
8	Small financial investment	Ease	2	Needs a major investment approved at board level	Needs a departmental budget	Fits within an existing team budget
9	Small time investment	Ease	3	More than 12 months	3 to 6 months	Less than 1 month
10	Data readiness ADDED	Ease	4	The data does not exist yet, or we cannot reach it	The data exists but needs cleaning, joining or agreed definitions	The data exists, is trusted, and we can reach it today
11	Low delivery risk ADDED	Ease	3	High risk - new technology, many dependencies, or legal or privacy exposure	Some risk, with known ways to reduce it	Low risk - a proven approach, few dependencies, no legal or privacy concerns

Scores

#	Use-case ID		UC-1		UC-2		UC-3	
	Title		Develop new data product		Gather customer contact data		Share customer contact data with supplier	
	Criterion	Weight (1–5)	Score	W × S	Score	W × S	Score	W × S
VALUE — HOW MUCH DOES THIS USE CASE MATTER TO THE BUSINESS?								
1	Supports corporate strategy How directly does it serve the corporate strategy?	5	5	25	3	15	4	20
2	Builds on a strength Does it use a strength named in the SWOT analysis?	2	5	10	2	4	2	4
3	Reduces a weakness Does it fix a weakness named in the SWOT analysis?	2	1	2	4	8	4	8
4	Defends against a threat Does it protect us from a threat named in the SWOT analysis?	4	4	16	1	4	2	8
5	Increases profit Will profit rise, for example through lower costs?	2	3	6	4	8	1	2
6	Increases revenue Will revenue rise?	3	5	15	3	9	2	6
7	Increases the number of customers Will it win new customers or keep existing ones?	4	5	20	2	8	3	12
EASE — HOW EASILY CAN WE DELIVER IT WITH THE MONEY, TIME AND DATA WE HAVE?								
8	Small financial investment How much money does it need?	2	2	4	2	4	4	8
9	Small time investment How long will it take to implement?	3	1	3	1	3	2	6
10	Data readiness ADDED Does the data exist, can we trust it, and can we reach it?	4	3†	12	1†	4	2†	8
11	Low delivery risk ADDED How likely is it to be late, fail, or cause legal or privacy problems?	3	2†	6	3†	9	2†	6
Value total (add the W × S value rows)			94		56		60	
Value score = value total ÷ sum of value weights (22 by default)			4.27		2.55		2.73	
Ease total (add the W × S ease rows)			25		20		28	
Ease score = ease total ÷ sum of ease weights (12 by default)			2.08		1.67		2.33	
Overall total (out of 170 by default)			119 (70%)		76 (45%)		88 (52%)	
Quadrant (high = 3.0 or more)			Strategic bet		Deprioritise		Deprioritise	

† Illustrative score: the seed template did not score data readiness or delivery risk. These values only show how the two added criteria work.

With the seed's nine criteria alone, the totals are UC-1 101, UC-2 63 and UC-3 74. The seed printed 98 for UC-1; its rows add up to 101.

Next: Place each use case on the prioritisation matrix (step 3) using its value and ease scores.